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My hope and prayer is to see a society free of corneal blindness and deaths due to shortage of blood.

CHIRANJEEVI, Actor

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ising camps, on an average once a week, with the help of CEBB. Chiranjeevi's fans in Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Maharashtra and Orissa, too, have formed blood donation groups.

CEBB issues blood free of cost to those who come with relevant documents from hospitals and doctors and also screens donors' blood for free. It absorbs the screening cost—nearly Rs 800—for every donor. The richer, availing of treatment at corporate hospitals, get the blood free but are asked to pay Rs 375 as a token fee for the screening test of the donor to partially meet the expenses incurred by the blood bank. Having

streamlined the supply by creating databases of those willing to donate their blood group, location and access, CEBB has been adjudged the voluntary blood bank in Andhra Pradesh for five years in a row since 2003. relying on fractionation, the bank gives platelets or plasma depending on the need instead of the entire blood in order to make optimal use. Blood components are most beneficial for patients needing critical care.

That is not all. The two-storey building, its facilities and the salaries of its member staff are paid for by Chiranjeevi himself from what he receives as celebrity endorsement fees. Already he has invested more than Rs 5 crore of his own money. Also, he is persuading movie stars to pledge their corneas to help restore vision to the visually challenged. With more than 50,000 pledging their eyes posthumously, CEBB will, in the years ahead, enable many more to gain vision too.

Clearly, a lesson or two to the Bollywood biggies in how to convert celebrity glamour into social significance.